

Environmental & Wildlife Protection Laws Matrix

CROSS-REFERENCE MANUAL: PUBLIC SAFETY, ECOLOGY, FORESTRY & SPECIAL PENAL ENACTMENTS

Comprehensive analysis covering penal provisions, description vectors, sentencing matrices, and specialized statutory exclusions.

ACT & SECTION	NAME OF CRIME	DESCRIPTION	PUNISHMENT	BNS EQUIVALENT	KEYWORDS
WPA, 1972 – Sec. 9	Hunting of Wild Animals	Prohibits hunting, capturing, poisoning or trapping protected wild animals.	Imprisonment 3–7 years and fine (higher for repeat offences).	Not Applicable (Special Law)	hunting, poaching, wild animals
WPA, 1972 – Sec. 39	Illegal Possession of Wildlife Property	Possession or control of animal articles, trophies, or uncured trophies without authority.	Punishable under Sec. 51.	Not Applicable	possession, trophy, animal article
WPA, 1972 – Sec. 44	Trade and Commerce without Licence	Carrying on business in animal articles or trophies without licence.	Punishable under Sec. 51.	Not Applicable	trade, licence, commerce
WPA, 1972 – Sec. 48A	Transportation of Wildlife without Permission	Transporting wild animals or animal products illegally.	Punishable under Sec. 51.	Not Applicable	transport, wildlife products
WPA, 1972 – Sec. 49B	Prohibition of Trade in Scheduled Animals	Buying, selling, processing or dealing in scheduled animal products.	Imprisonment 3–7 years and fine.	Not Applicable	illegal trade, ivory, tiger skin
WPA, 1972 – Sec. 50	Search, Seizure and Arrest	Powers of officers to search, seize and arrest offenders.	Procedural provision.	Not Applicable	search, seizure, arrest
WPA, 1972 – Sec. 51	Penalties for Wildlife Offences	General punishment provision for contravention of the Act.	3–7 years imprisonment and fine up to ₹25,000 or more.	Not Applicable	punishment, wildlife offence
EPA, 1986 – Sec. 15	Violation of Environmental Standards	Contravention of provisions of the Act or rules.	Imprisonment up to 5 years or fine up to ₹1 lakh or both.	Not Applicable	pollution, environment
Water Act, 1974 – Sec. 41	Water Pollution	Discharging pollutants into water bodies.	Imprisonment 1½–6 years and fine.	Not Applicable	water pollution
Air Act, 1981 – Sec. 37	Air Pollution	Failure to comply with standards prescribed by Pollution Control Boards.	Imprisonment 1½–6 years and fine.	Not Applicable	air pollution, emissions
IFA, 1927 – Sec. 26	Forest Offences	Illegal felling, clearing or damaging reserved forests.	Imprisonment up to 6 months or fine or both.	Not Applicable	forest, timber, deforestation
FCA, 1980 – Sec. 3A	Violation of Forest Conservation Provisions	Use of forest land for non-forest purposes without approval.	Simple imprisonment up to 15 days.	Not Applicable	forest land, diversion
WPA, 1972 – Sec. 54	Compounding of Certain Offences	Authorizes compounding of minor offences.	Administrative provision.	Not Applicable	compounding

ACT & SECTION	NAME OF CRIME	DESCRIPTION	PUNISHMENT	BNS EQUIVALENT	KEYWORDS
WPA, 1972 – Sec. 55	Cognizance of Offences	Specifies who can file complaints.	Procedural provision.	Not Applicable	cognizance, complaint